

Conductors and insulators

Some materials, such as metals, allow electricity and heat to pass through them easily. We call these conductors. Other materials, such as plastic, don't allow electricity or heat to pass through them easily. They are called insulators. We use conductors and insulators for different jobs.

Glass doesn't conduct electricity or heat well. It is an insulator, so helps to keep drinks hot or cold.

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Which of these are good conductors?

Diamond is unusual as it conducts heat well, but it is an insulator of electricity.

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Plastics are good insulators. Electrical wires often have a plastic coating to keep the electricity inside the wire.

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